

# Subscription spending survey

What do young Indians pay for monthly,  
and what makes them cancel?

A short survey of 22 to 30 year olds in India. This document is the design: questions, sampling, analysis plan and limits. Results are added once responses are collected.

# What do 22 to 30 year olds in India pay for every month, and what makes them cancel?

## Hypotheses to test, written before any data is collected

### H1

Most respondents hold 2 to 4 paid subscriptions, led by video, music and food or shopping memberships.

### H2

Cancellations cluster after free trials and price rises, not after loss of interest alone.

### H3

Sharing a plan with family or friends is common and lowers the price people say is fair.

A hypothesis can be wrong. If the data disagrees, the result is reported as it came.

# Short, anonymous and built for a phone

## Question

Which subscriptions do 22 to 30 year olds keep, what do they spend, and why do they cancel?

## Respondents

Aged 22 to 30, living in India, paying for at least one subscription in the last 3 months.

## Format

Google Form, short, anonymous, mobile first. Time to be measured in the pilot, target 4 minutes.

# Sections A to D: who answers and what they report

| Section             | Questions                                                                                                                                 | Answer type   |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| <b>A. Screen</b>    | Age band (under 22 / 22 to 25 / 26 to 30 / over 30); lives in India; paid for any subscription in last 3 months                           | Single choice |
| <b>B. Profile</b>   | City type (metro / tier-1 / tier-2 / smaller town); work status; monthly personal income band                                             | Single choice |
| <b>C. Inventory</b> | Which categories do you pay for now? Video, music, news, fitness, food or shopping membership, software or cloud, gaming, learning, other | Multi-select  |
| <b>D. Spend</b>     | Total monthly subscription spend (bands from under ₹200 to over ₹2,000); is any plan shared or paid by someone else                       | Single choice |

# Sections E to I: the core questions

| Section          | Questions                                                                                                                        | Answer type   |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| <b>E. Start</b>  | What made you start your most used subscription? Trial, a specific title or feature, bundle or offer, friend, need               | Single choice |
| <b>F. Cancel</b> | Cancelled any in the last 6 months? Main reason: price, price rise, trial ended, not using, found alternative, shared plan ended | Single choice |
| <b>G. Value</b>  | Rate worth for money on your top 3 subscriptions, 1 to 5                                                                         | Rating        |
| <b>H. Price</b>  | Four price questions for one chosen category: too cheap, cheap, getting expensive, too expensive (Van Westendorp)                | Number        |
| <b>I. Open</b>   | What one subscription would you never cancel, and why?                                                                           | Free text     |

# Each question has a planned table before data arrives

| Topic        | What is computed                                                     | Output                                        |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Ownership    | Share holding each category; mean and median number held             | Percent with 95% interval                     |
| Spend        | Distribution of monthly spend by band and by income band             | Medians, band shares                          |
| Cancellation | Share who cancelled; reasons ranked; trial versus price-rise reasons | Counts, cross-tab by spend band               |
| Price        | Acceptable price range from the four price questions, per category   | Cumulative curves, only where n is 30 or more |
| Shared plans | Spend and cancel rate for shared versus own plans                    | Cross-tab, flagged if cell under 10           |

# A small convenience sample, so results describe respondents only

## How people are reached

Personal and professional contacts, and their forwards. Target is 100 or more valid responses. No incentive is offered, which keeps answers honest but lowers response.

## What this cannot claim

Not a random sample, so no claim about all young Indians. Contacts skew urban, educated and in white-collar work. Every chart states n, and groups under 10 are not shown.

# Anonymous by design

## Collected

Age band, city type, broad function and answers. No name, email, phone number or employer name is asked for. The form does not require a Google sign-in.

## Shown to respondents

A short opening note: who runs the survey and why, that it is voluntary and anonymous, and that results will be published in aggregate on a public portfolio.

# What would make the findings stronger

| Limit              | Why it matters                             | How to reduce it                                                      |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Convenience sample | Results may not match the wider population | Report n and profile; compare with published figures where they exist |
| Self-report        | People misremember spend or reasons        | Use bands and short recall windows                                    |
| Small subgroups    | Percentages swing with few answers         | Hide cells under 10; show intervals                                   |
| Pilot not yet run  | Wording may confuse                        | Test with 5 people and fix before wider sending                       |